PRE-BIBLE PITCH SHEET

Airdate: **Wednesday, Nov 11, 2026** (F2, tapes Fri Nov 6) · **One story** (producer, 11/2): a longer A, about 20–25% over a usual A, with more clips · Prepared Mon, Nov 2, 2026 · Built on Jeff's 11/04 notes · Audience 55+.

THE SHORTLIST — RANKED

#	Story	Lead title	Viral clip (with link)
1	**THE BURGLARS ARE WATCHING YOUR HOUSE FROM THE BUSHES**	Burglars Are SPYING On Your House — Check Your BUSHES Tonight!	NBC News, ~497K, Apr 2025: youtube.com/watch?v=kEQircxHdHQ · NBC News jammers, ~361K, Dec 2025: youtube.com/watch?v=LuNTbekmqnM

HOW THIS WAS BUILT: the producer set the story; I searched the camera cases by place and date (2024 to Oct 2026: police warnings in five states and Canada, plus an eight-state ring), then the ways crews learn a schedule (Wi-Fi jammers, fake delivery knocks, travel posts, car trackers, obituaries). Seven angles made it into the show; the stories-inside-the-story page has all of them, with what's in and what's out.

SLATE FIT: Fills the show. A scam-grade villain (an organized crew), the viewer's own front door, a success story with arrests, a real loss, a fresh case (Oct 2026), and a fix every viewer can do tonight. Six outside clips, verified against transcripts of the outlets' own site videos. Weak spots: the best success story is from 2024 (date it on air), and no 2026 case has a dollar figure. No guest booked; see the open questions.

1. THE BURGLARS ARE WATCHING YOUR HOUSE FROM THE BUSHES

Status: READY · one-story show · **Score:** 13/14 (Fear 2, Heat 2, Track record 2, Breadth 2, Peg 1, Newness 2, Producibility 2) · **Lead test:** passes 2 of 3 (not 1M+ in 75 days)

POTENTIAL PACKAGING

- Burglars Are SPYING On Your House — Check Your BUSHES Tonight!
- If You Find THIS In Your Bushes — DON'T TOUCH IT
- The NEW Burglar Trick — They Know EXACTLY When You Leave

Built on: "spy" titles 7.8x, threat titles 1.7x; the If-You-See-THIS pattern; "You Let Them In" (2.2x). Not "hidden" (0.5x).

THE PITCH

Police say burglary crews hide cameras in bushes across the street, aimed at your door, to learn when you come and go, then break in. Found in five states, most recently Rancho Cucamonga last month; the same crews jam Wi-Fi cameras and knock dressed as delivery drivers. Peg: holiday travel. Every viewer can walk their yard tonight.

CASES

- **Braintree, MA (June–July 2024).** Burglarized on vacation (their camera shows a masked man crawling in the living room). A neighbor found a taped camera in the bushes; police had the family fake a second trip and arrested three who came back for it. *CBS Boston, WCVB, Jul 16, 2024.* CHECK: date it.
- **West Hills, LA (Mar 20, 2025).** A neighbor saw two people plant something in a bush at 2 a.m.; at 11 a.m. a masked crew ran out of a home with bags and grabbed the camera on the way. *CBS LA, Mar 20, 2025.*
- **Irvine, CA (Easter 2025).** A knock, then a fake Amazon driver; three men leave with a suitcase; the homeowner says tens of thousands gone. Five arrested. *ABC7, May 2025.*
- **Rancho Cucamonga (Oct 2026)** cameras found twice in two weeks; **LA County (May 20, 2026)** seven charged, cameras in turf-covered boxes plus Wi-Fi jammers. *CBS LA 10/7/26; ABC7 5/20/26.* LEGAL: "police say"; not-guilty pleas.

VIRAL CLIP — NBC News, ~497K views (observed 11/2), story date Apr 30, 2025
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kEQircxHdHQ
Not watched — no timecode, no outcue here. YouTube upload dates unconfirmed (bot wall).

COVERAGE CHECK

Never a segment (transcripts Mar 18 to Sep 29). Closest: rental cameras (Aug 19) and Flock (Aug 5, flopped; this camera is the burglar's). Not checked: after Oct 21, filmed-not-aired.

FOOTAGE WE NEED

- **The get:** CBS Boston's Braintree package (crawl video, neighbor, trap); then CBS LA, ABC7, NBC. **Demo:** Jeff walks a yard with a mock-up bush camera.

THE PAYOFF

- **The two-minute walk: bushes, planters, fences and the yard across the street, for anything pointed at a door** (Whittier PD, Brea PD, LASD).
- **Found one? Don't touch it. Call police** (LASD, Rancho Cucamonga PD). That's how Braintree caught them.
- Hard-wired cameras resist jammers (Sheriff Luna). Answer a knock through the door (Burbank PD). Post the trip after you're home (LA officials).

THE STORIES INSIDE THE STORY

Each angle, with what it adds and whether it's in the show. The outline puts them in this order.

1. THEY GOT CAUGHT — Braintree (IN, beat 2: the real result)

Neighbor finds the camera, police stage a fake vacation, the crew walks back into the trap. **Adds:** the result Jeff wants early, plus a loss (the break-in) in the same package. Clip: CBS Boston site video. Dated 2024.

2. IT'S HERE NOW — Rancho Cucamonga (IN, beat 3: the peg)

Cameras twice in two weeks this fall; a couple 40 years in their home, burglarized twice, go check their bushes. **Adds:** stakes, a 55+ face, a 2026 date. Clip: CBS LA, ~192K.

3. NINE HOURS — West Hills (IN, beat 4)

Planted at 2 a.m., house emptied at 11 a.m., camera picked up on the way out. The neighbor watched and didn't call. **Adds:** stakes (hours, not weeks) and the first tell: call it in that night.

4. WHO'S WATCHING — the crews (IN, beat 5)

LA County charged seven in May; police say crews used turf-covered camera boxes and Wi-Fi jammers. A Michigan-based ring hit 20+ homes in 8 states, $1.5M+, prosecutors said. **Adds:** a development (organized, caught, across the country). Keep "police say"; never generalize past the charged crews.

5. YOUR CAMERA GOES DARK — Wi-Fi jammers (IN, beat 6)

A doorbell picture warps as thieves walk up (Bellaire, TX). Jammers cost $60–70, police say. **Adds:** the next risk: the viewer's own camera won't save them. Clip: NBC News, ~361K.

6. THEY KNOCK FIRST — fake delivery drivers (IN, beat 7)

Irvine, Easter 2025: a knock, a fake Amazon driver, a suitcase out the side; police: be wary of a delivery you didn't order. Burbank PD: knock-knock burglars check whether anyone's home. **Adds:** the threat reaches the door, and a tell viewers can use today. Clip: ABC7.

7. THEY READ YOUR POSTS — travel on social media (JEFF LINE)

LA officials (5/20/26) said crews used social media to learn when people were away. No clip or named case found. One Jeff line in the lock-down beat.

8. TRACKERS ON YOUR CAR (OPTION, JEFF LINE)

Michigan (Fox 17) and Abington, PA (KYW, 2025): police say crews put GPS trackers on cars to know when owners were at work. No clip pulled. A strong line if the room wants one more "how they know."

9. FUNERAL AND OBITUARY BURGLARIES (OUT)

Real (Jacksonville, Las Vegas, Milford clips exist), but our gate rules it too niche: the viewer has to have a recent death in the family (round 1 verdict). Banked for a different show.

RESEARCH SOURCES & VERIFICATION FLAGS

READ THIS FIRST

- **I cannot watch video.** Clips are described from titles, pages and transcripts. Timecodes and outcues live only in the outline, from Whisper transcripts of the outlets' own site videos (cbsnews.com, nbcnews.com, abc7.com/abc13.com); YouTube blocked every per-video lookup on 11/2 (two tries, 5+ minutes apart). The YouTube copies may run a few seconds off the site cuts.
- YouTube **search** worked: view counts are from 11/2. Upload dates are the outlets' story dates; confirm before the bible.
- The schedule-angles research was cut short; travel posts, car trackers and obituary burglaries rest on the sources below only.

STORY 1 — BURGLARS WATCHING FROM THE BUSHES

Confirmed:

- Braintree, MA: break-in Jun 20, 2024 while the family was away; neighbor found a camera taped in the bushes across the street; police had the family fake a vacation; on Jul 11, 2024 a man returned to the camera and was arrested after a foot chase, two women in a getaway car. Lt. Det. Brian Cohoon: "We set a trap, they took the bait." Police tie the three to "South American Theft Groups" (CBS Boston, WCVB, Jul 16, 2024).
- West Hills, LA, Mar 20, 2025: neighbor saw two people put something in a bush at ~2 a.m.; at ~11 a.m. four or five masked people left a home with bags and went back to the camera. No arrests reported (CBS LA, Mar 20, 2025; KTLA via Yahoo, Mar 21, 2025).
- Rancho Cucamonga PD, Oct 6–8, 2026: cameras near homes on two occasions in two weeks; no arrests; "don't touch or remove them" (CBS LA, Oct 7, 2026; KTLA via Yahoo, Oct 8, 2026).
- LA County, May 20, 2026: DA Hochman, Sheriff Luna, LAPD Chief McDonnell, Ventura Co. Sheriff Fryhoff; seven charged with first-degree residential burglary, all pleaded not guilty; hidden cameras in turf-wrapped boxes and Wi-Fi jammers in at least three burglaries; Luna: "If you see anything that looks like this in your neighbor's home, in your home, report it to us immediately." Hard-wired systems are harder to disable (ABC7, NBC LA, Westside Current, May 20–21, 2026).
- Irvine, CA, Easter Sunday 2025: Ring footage of a woman knocking, then a man dressed as an Amazon driver; three men leave with a backpack and suitcase; homeowner lost "tens of thousands of dollars" in things; five arrested about a month later, police say tied to a Colombian crew (ABC7 via ABC13, May 17, 2025).
- Bellaire, TX: doorbell video glitches as thieves approach; police say a jammer; "$60 or $70," range "10 to 20 feet"; experts: hard-wired system, SD-card recording (NBC News, Dec 5, 2025; KPRC, Dec 2, 2025).
- Burbank police: knock-knock burglars; "never open the door for a stranger"; make your presence known without confronting anyone (CBS LA, Feb 23, 2025).
- Michigan-based ring: 20+ homes, 8 states, "over $1,500,000," "hidden surveillance cameras to watch potential victims"; six sentenced Apr 9, 2026 (Fox News, Apr 9, 2026; WNEM, Apr 10, 2026).
- Police yard advice: walk the yard, check bushes and planters, trim shrubs (Whittier PD via KTLA 9/16/26; Brea PD via KTLA 6/23/26; LASD via Patch 5/15/26); tell your gardener (LASD Lost Hills via ABC7 5/29/24).

Sources: cbsnews.com/boston/news/braintree-burglaries-hidden-camera-spy/ · cbsnews.com/boston/news/braintree-spy-camera-international-crime-ring · cbsnews.com/losangeles/news/suspects-break-into-west-hills-home-during-daytime-burglary · cbsnews.com/losangeles/news/rancho-cucamonga-hidden-cameras-police-warning/ · yahoo.com/news/articles/rancho-cucamonga-police-issue-warning-175231511.html · abc7.com/post/7-arrested-socal-home-burglaries-tied-south-american-theft-group-authorities-say/19138631/ · abc7.com/videoClip/19140194/ · westsidecurrent.com (DoorDash delivery trick, May 2026) ·

abc13.com/post/members-international-organized-residential-burglary-ring-arrested-posing-amazon-drivers-irvine-ca-break-video/16472783/ · nbcnews.com/news/amp-video/mmvo253857861920 · nbcnews.com/news/amp-video/mmvo238585413773 · cbsnews.com/losangeles/news/burbank-police-warn-residents-of-rise-in-knock-knock-burglaries · foxnews.com/us/judge-describes-illegal-immigrant-burglary-crews-cross-country-operation-oceans-eleven-style-conduct · wnem.com/2026/04/10/6-undocumented-immigrants-sentenced-multistate-burglary-ring/ · patch.com/california/los-angeles/hidden-cameras-found-outside-homes-likely-planted-burglary-stakeouts-lasd · Full case file: runs/W_11112026/research/research_bush_cameras.md

NEEDS VERIFICATION:

- **The cold open's line, "the camera belongs to the crew that's about to rob you," is an inference in most cases.** Police tie the camera to the burglary in Braintree, West Hills, San Dimas and Whittier; elsewhere a camera was found and nothing happened (Rancho Cucamonga, West Covina). Say "police say" and lead with a case where both happened.
- The strongest success story is from 2024. Jeff dates it ("two summers ago, outside Boston"). No 2025–2026 success came from a homeowner's find; the 2026 arrests came from other police work.
- No dollar loss in any camera case except the Michigan ring, and there the link to a specific camera rests on one outlet (Voz). Irvine's "tens of thousands" is the homeowner's own figure, and Irvine isn't a camera case.
- Braintree arrest count: CBS Boston and WCVB say three; NBC's national report says four. Use three.
- "South American theft groups" is the police's phrase. LEGAL: attribute it every time; never broaden it to a nationality or to immigrants.
- Car trackers and travel posts: officials' statements only, no clip or named victim.
- FCC rule that jammers are illegal to use or sell: not loaded; verify at fcc.gov before Jeff says it.
- West Covina (2025): the homeowner kicked the camera out. Police say don't touch it, so don't use him as the model.

STORIES CUT — SOURCING PRESERVED

- Funeral / obituary burglaries: Jacksonville arrests (News4JAX BH41BcnKo6w), Las Vegas (KTNV uRyHcqNnv1M), Milford, MA (CBS Boston kA7SCWe9Ook); not dated or verified. Cut as niche.
- Temecula (May–Sept 2024): homeowner's own video caught two masked men planting the device; three arrested (KTLA, Sep 5, 2024). A backup success story.
- NBC News national (Apr 2025, ~497K): the viral clip, held as the alternate for beat 3; it overlaps Rancho Cucamonga and is older.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE MEETING

- **Guest or no guest?** A one-story F2 has room for one: a retired burglary detective or a home-security expert to walk the yard with Jeff. Nobody's booked; who do we call?
- **Lead with Braintree (2024, success plus loss) or Rancho Cucamonga (Oct 2026, fresh, no arrests)?** Jeff's note says a real result first, so Braintree, then Rancho as "and it's here now."
- **Demo:** do we build a mock bush camera and shoot Jeff walking a yard? It's the payoff, and it's the stop-and-check moment.
- **Title:** "SPYING" (7.8x word) or "DON'T TOUCH IT" (the If-You-See pattern)?
- **Car trackers:** one Jeff line, or leave out?